

Final Interview Checklist

After you successfully complete the initial screening and interview rounds, you will be scheduled for a final interview. This is a huge accomplishment. Your initial interviews will be conducted by HR, a recruiter, or possibly your future boss. The final interview will normally be conducted by someone from higher management. You must be ready! The stakes have never been higher.

Use the checklist below to ensure you are ready to succeed in the final interview.

Preparation Step	Recommendations
Be well rested	• A final interview may take anywhere between 15 minutes to several hours. • Get plenty of rest the night before and be mentally ready.
Research	• Determine who will be interviewing you. HR will normally share this information. • Research the interviewer on social media. Try to learn as much as you can about their background, values, accomplishments, and so on. • Use the knowledge gained from research to your advantage.
Complete the pre-work	• Understand what the interviewer expects from you. • Ensure you accomplish all pre-work and are prepared. For example—some final interviews may require you to give a presentation.
Differentiate yourself	• Be ready to share the unique value you can bring to the firm. Refine your "why" pitch. Share why they should say yes to you and why you want to work for the company. • Research the job description—and match your skills to the position. • Try to create and memorize a unique value proposition. This is a good time to repeat your elevator pitch. • Be prepared to respond to behavioral questions.
Quantify	• Be prepared to show credible numbers you helped to achieve. For example revenue, cost savings, reduced process time, and improved customer satisfaction. • Quantify your work as much as possible.
Commitment	• Show you are committed for the "long haul." • Final interviews are expensive. Show the hiring team they will get return on investment by hiring you. • Show how you can contribute to the organization's goals.
Be ready to discuss salary	• A final interview normally includes salary discussions. • Be prepared. Do your research. Understand the "going rate" for a like position. • Discuss acceptable salary ranges—but DON'T negotiate at the interview unless you receive a formal job offer. • Don't sell yourself short!
Attitude	• The final interview may be stressful. • Maintain a positive attitude—no matter what. • Always stay professional.
Your questions	• Have at least three questions you will ask at the end of the interview. • Ask informed questions.
Follow up	• Find out the email addresses of the interviewers. You may ask them for a business card or get this information from HR. • Send a thank you email to each member of the interview panel within 24 hours of the interview.



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